

name: charity-donor-outreach

description: >-

Use this skill when the user has a donor list or CRM export (CSV/spreadsheet) with donor giving history and wants to generate personalized fundraising outreach letters for a specific campaign. Do not use this skill for general fundraising questions, grant writing, event planning, or communications tasks that do not involve generating donor letters from a donor data file.

Charity Donor Outreach Letter Generator

Generates personalized, tier-appropriate donor outreach letters from a donor data file for a specified campaign. Designed to produce accurate, auditable, review-ready drafts – not final letters that bypass staff review.

Required inputs

Before proceeding, confirm you have:

1. A donor data file (CSV or spreadsheet) – read at run time. Never hardcode donor data into this skill. Expected columns: donor name, title (optional), tier or lifetime giving total, region, largest single gift, last gift year, volunteer status (yes/no).
2. Charity identity details: charity name, donation URL, and the name/title of whoever is signing the letter. If these are not supplied, ask the user for them rather than inventing them.
3. Campaign type: Emergency Appeal, Annual Fund, Capital Campaign, or Event Fundraiser. If not specified, ask the user rather than defaulting silently.
4. Matching gift status: whether a match is actually confirmed for this campaign, and if so, the match ratio/cap. Never state or imply a gift will be matched unless the user has explicitly confirmed a match exists.

Step 1 – Validate the data

For each donor record, check that tier (or lifetime giving, from which tier can be derived), largest single gift, and last gift year are present.

- If a record is missing any of these fields, do not guess. Exclude that donor from the letter batch and list them separately as "needs manual review" with the specific missing field(s), so staff can fill the gap.
- If tier is not supplied but lifetime giving is, derive tier from the table below. If neither is present, the record goes to manual review – do not default to Bronze, since that could under-ask a donor who simply has an incomplete record.

Donor Tiers

Platinum (> \$50,000 lifetime): Very formal. Ask 40% of largest gift.

Personal relationship manager name required – pull from data, never invent.

Mention naming opportunity.

Gold (\$10,000–\$49,999): Warm, professional. Ask 25% of largest gift.

Mention legacy giving options.

Silver (\$1,000–\$9,999): Friendly. Ask 15% of largest gift.

Mention monthly giving upgrade.

Bronze (< \$1,000): Casual, encouraging. Flat \$150 ask.

Mention peer fundraising pages.

Lapsed (no gift in 3+ years): Warm, welcoming (not apologetic).
Flat \$50 "restart" gift.

Note on Lapsed tone: avoid an apologetic register ("we've failed you") – it can read as presumptuous about why the donor stopped giving. Use a warm re-engagement tone instead ("we'd love to have you back").

A record with a tier value not in this table, or with no derivable tier, goes to manual review – do not default to Bronze/Unknown automatically.

Campaign Types and Messaging Angles

Emergency Appeal: Urgency language is fine when the need is real. Only reference gift matching if matching gift status (see Required Inputs) was explicitly confirmed for this campaign – state the exact match ratio/cap given, never a general or invented claim of matching.

Annual Fund: Focus on consistency and community. Mention the donor's giving streak only if the data shows consecutive years of giving.

Capital Campaign: Focus on legacy and permanence.

Event Fundraiser: Focus on community and turnout. Only cite a specific registration number if it was provided by the user – do not invent one.

If campaign type is missing, ask the user. Do not silently default.

Step 2 – Calculate the ask amount

Compute this explicitly and show the work for each donor (for auditability):

```
base = largest_single_gift x tier_percentage    # Platinum/Gold/Silver only
base = round(base, nearest $50)
if donor gave last year: base *= 1.10          # loyalty uplift
if donor is a volunteer: base += 100
if campaign == "Emergency Appeal": base *= 1.20
ask_amount = base

# Bronze: ask_amount = $150 flat (skip the above)
# Lapsed: ask_amount = $50 flat (skip the above)
```

Sanity check (required): ask_amount must never exceed the donor's lifetime giving total. If the formula produces a number that does, cap the ask at a reasonable fraction of lifetime giving and flag the donor for a quick staff sanity check rather than sending as-is.

Step 3 – Salutation

- Platinum and Gold: "Dear [Title] [Last Name]," – only if the title is present.
- All other cases (incl. Platinum/Gold with no title on file), Silver, Bronze: "Dear [First Name] [Last Name],"
- Lapsed: "We'd love to have you back, [First Name],"
- Never infer a title/honorific from a first name. If a title isn't in the data, don't use one.

Step 4 – Draft the letter

Use the template below. Every bracketed field must come from the donor data file or the charity identity details supplied in Required Inputs – never invented.

```

<html>
<body style="font-family: Georgia; padding: 30px; max-width: 600px; color: #222;">
  <p style="text-align:right; color: #888;">[DATE]</p>
  <p>[SALUTATION]</p>
  <p>On behalf of everyone at <strong>[CHARITY NAME]</strong>, thank you for
  your generosity. Your lifetime support of <strong>${LIFETIME_GIVING}</strong>
  has made a real difference.</p>
  <p>[CAMPAIGN_PARAGRAPH - 2 sentences of campaign-specific messaging per
  the section above, using only confirmed facts]</p>
  <p>Today, I'd like to invite you to make a gift of
  <strong>${ASK_AMOUNT}</strong>. [TIER_SPECIFIC_LINE]</p>
  <p>To give, simply reply to this email or visit our donation page at
  <strong>[DONATION_URL]</strong>.</p>
  <p>With gratitude,<br>
  <strong>[SIGNER_NAME]</strong><br>
  [SIGNER_TITLE], [CHARITY NAME]</p>
</body>
</html>

```

Step 5 – Output for review (not send-ready)

- Label every letter clearly as a draft for staff review – this skill produces review-ready drafts, not final donor communications.
- For batches, save each letter as a separate file named draft_[donor_last_name]_[first_name].html in an output folder, plus a single summary file listing: donor name, tier, ask amount, and the calculation steps from Step 2.
- Also output the "needs manual review" list from Step 1 separately, with the reason each donor was excluded.
- Do not dump large batches only into the chat window – for more than a handful of donors, write files so the batch is usable and reviewable.

Data handling

Donor giving history is sensitive financial information. Don't reproduce it outside the letters and summary file being generated, don't retain it beyond the task, and flag to the user if the data file appears to contain more sensitive information than needed (e.g., SSNs, bank details).